Which Benefit Am I On

FIND YOURS

I don’t know which benefit I’m on

Has a VR&E counselor approved a plan for your degree?

Yes:

You’re on VR&E · Chapter 31. Your counselor sends ODU the authorization · Plan, books, monthly money → your counselor · Your months left → your counselor → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC)*

No:

Do you have a Certificate of Eligibility (COE) or award letter?

Yes:

The letter names your chapter. Look for “Chapter” and a number · GI Bill letters also show months left · Then see what it pays

No, or can’t find it:

Check online, or by phone?

Online:

VA’s remaining-benefits check. Sign in on your own device · Post-9/11? You can also download the decision letter → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

By phone:

Call VA, or ask the SCO. VA’s call center tells you your chapter · Or ask ODU’s SCO what’s been certified for you → *VA Education Call Center, School Certifying Official (SCO)*

Not sure:

Your VA Regional Office can tell you. Ask for the VR&E Supervisor · No case? Come back and pick “No” → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC)*

Could I qualify for one I’m not using?

Which sounds most like you?

I have a VA disability rating:

10% or more? You may apply for VR&E. Apply on VA Form 28-1900 · Using VR&E doesn’t take months from your GI Bill → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC)*

Still serving, no rating yet:

Service members: VA Form 28-0588. At least one must be true · None fits? A VSO can help with the claim first → *An accredited Veterans Service Officer (VSO)*

I served on active duty after 9/10/2001:

Post-9/11 GI Bill · VA Form 22-1990. 90 days or more pays a tier · Apply online → *VA Education Call Center*

I paid into the Montgomery GI Bill, or I’m in the Selected Reserve:

Montgomery GI Bill · Chapter 30 or 1606. Paid in on active duty → Chapter 30 · 6-year Selected Reserve obligation → Chapter 1606 · Apply on VA Form 22-1990 → *VA Education Call Center*

I’m the child or spouse of a service member or Veteran:

Did the service member die on or after September 11, 2001, in the line of duty or from a service-connected disability?

Yes:

Fry Scholarship, and maybe DEA. Fry pays at the Post-9/11 100% level · Apply on VA Form 22-5490 → *VA Education Call Center*

No, or it’s a disability, missing or captured:

DEA · Chapter 35 · VA Form 22-5490. VA lists six routes · Not sure it fits? Apply. VA decides. → *VA Education Call Center*

WHAT IT PAYS

What does my benefit pay?

Which benefit?

Post-9/11 GI Bill or Fry:

Tuition to ODU, housing and books to you. Tuition and fees → ODU, at the in-state rate · Housing: about $2,430 a month at ODU's main campus · Books: up to $1,000 a year → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

VR&E:

Your plan's costs, plus a monthly allowance. Tuition, fees, books, supplies → paid for you · Full time: $837.23 · $1,038.49 one dependent · $1,223.79 two · Or the Post-9/11 housing rate, if you're eligible and elect it → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC)*

Montgomery, Active Duty:

Did you serve at least 3 continuous years on active duty?

Yes, 3 years or more:

$2,601.00 a month, full time. Paid to you; you pay ODU · Less at ¾ or ½ time → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

Between 2 and 3 years:

$2,110.00 a month, full time. Paid to you; you pay ODU · Less at ¾ or ½ time → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

Montgomery, Selected Reserve:

$508.00 a month, full time. Paid to you; you pay ODU · Less at ¾ or ½ time; $127.00 below half → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

DEA:

$1,621.00 a month, full time. Paid to you; you pay ODU · Less at ¾ or ½ time → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

Yellow Ribbon or the STEM Scholarship:

Which add-on?

Yellow Ribbon:

Covers tuition above the Post-9/11 cap. For Post-9/11 at 100%, or Fry · ODU takes part → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

Rogers STEM Scholarship:

Up to 9 more months or $30,000. For Post-9/11 or Fry students near the end of entitlement · Tuition to ODU first, then books and housing → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

Will I get the Post-9/11 housing allowance?

Are you on active duty, or a spouse using transferred benefits while the Veteran is on active duty?

Yes:

No housing allowance while on active duty. Tuition and fees are still paid · It starts once that changes → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

No:

More than half time?

Yes:

Is at least one class in person?

Yes:

Yes, at the ZIP rate for where you attend. About $2,430 a month at ODU's main campus · Scaled by your credits and your tier → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

All online:

Yes, at the online rate: up to $1,198. Half the national average · One in-person class lifts the whole term to the ZIP rate → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

Half time or less:

No housing at half time or less. Exactly half is not "more than half" · Add one class to cross the line → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

What counts as full time at ODU?

Which are you?

Undergraduate:

12 credits in fall, spring or summer. Shorter sessions are converted by VA · The SCO certifies which standard applies → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

Graduate on campus, or doctoral or EdS:

9 credits across the full term. 16-week and 8-week classes add together · The SCO certifies which standard applies → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

ODUGlobal master's:

4.5 credits in one eight-week term. Counted per eight-week term, not the semester · The SCO certifies which standard applies → *School Certifying Official (SCO)*

CHOOSING AND SWITCHING

VR&E or the GI Bill: what's different?

What do you want to compare?

Getting in:

A rating and a counselor, versus service time. VR&E: a 10%+ rating lets you apply · GI Bill: your service sets it → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC), School Certifying Official (SCO)*

What each pays:

VR&E pays more of the costs. VR&E: tuition, fees, books, supplies, equipment · Post-9/11: tuition to the in-state cap, books up to $1,000 → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC), School Certifying Official (SCO)*

Using both:

Use VR&E first if you can. VR&E doesn't take months from your GI Bill · GI Bill benefits cap at 48 months combined → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC)*

Can I switch, or use two benefits?

What are you thinking of?

Montgomery and Post-9/11 both:

Your earlier choice may not be final. VA reviews files itself · Ask VA before revoking · Combined limit: 48 months, not at the same time → *VA Education Call Center, An accredited Veterans Service Officer (VSO)*

Moving to VR&E:

Next term, not mid-term. Talk to your counselor before the term starts · Tell the SCO too → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC), School Certifying Official (SCO)*

Another GI Bill chapter:

At the start of your next enrollment period. Apply to VA for the new chapter · Then a new clearance form for ODU → *VA Education Call Center, School Certifying Official (SCO)*

WHO TO ASK

Who do I ask about what?

What's it about?

My enrollment or school paperwork:

The School Certifying Official. Certifies your enrollment each term · Doesn't decide your benefit or rating → *School Certifying Official (SCO), Military Connection Center (MCC)*

A payment, a debt, or months left:

VA, by phone or in writing. Payment status, months left, letters, debts · Want it in writing? Use Ask VA → *VA Education Call Center, Ask VA, in writing*

My VR&E plan:

Your VR&E counselor. Plan, authorizations, books, allowance, switching · Can't reach them? The Regional Office's VR&E Supervisor → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC)*

My rating or a claim:

An accredited Veterans Service Officer. Claims, ratings and appeals · Always free → *An accredited Veterans Service Officer (VSO)*

Every answer's sources and contact details are on the page itself, at the address below.

In crisis, or worried about a Veteran? **Dial 988, then press 1**, or text 838255 — the Veterans Crisis Line, free and confidential, 24/7 (veteranscrisisline.net).

Not an official VA document and not a VA decision. Every figure is quoted from VA or ODU with its source and dates one tap away. VA's award governs your case, the School Certifying Official's certification governs your enrollment, and your VR&E counselor governs anything Chapter 31. Post-9/11 figures run to Jul 31, 2027; the others to Sep 30, 2027.

The kit: front door · Semester Pay Planner · Front-Desk Map (for the office).

Public address of this page: ferrelldevin.github.io/veteran-resources/education/odu-benefits-kit/benefit/

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